

Dubai- All Inclusive Travel Guide

Bon Voyage by Marina

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Suggested Itinerary with options

Title of Activity	Description of activity
Nov 1 Friday	Catch flight at 20:00 Arrives at 21:40 Transfer to Hotel: Marriott Marquis Dubai
Nov 2 Saturday	Visit LEGOLAND® Dubai in the Dubai Parks & Resorts Takes about 50 mins by car from the hotel to the Legoland Hours: 11 am to 8:00 pm Average time spent: All day Ticket Price: AED 590 / Rs. 13,500 for two The Dubai park also hosts Motiongate Dubai, Bollywood Parks Dubai and Legoland water park.
Nov 3 Sunday	Spend the day at Dubai Mall, one of the largest malls in the world where can visit the Dubai Aquarium & Underwater Zoo Takes about 20 mins by car from the hotel to the Dubai Mall (<i>no change in drive time with the hotel change</i>) Mall Hours: 10 am - 12 midnight Ticket Prices: The mall is free to enter, the aquarium and zoo has multiple packages and I would recommend buying the Ultimate Experience for AED 598 for two. The ultimate experience includes Penguin Cove & Nursery, Aqua Feast (Fish feeding), Glass Boat Tour and an AED 20 Food & Beverage voucher "Aquarium Café" in addition to everything that's

	included in the Regular Pass. The regular pass costs AED 100 less than the ultimate experience. Book tickets in advance and reserve the Glass boat tour timeslot as soon as you enter the Aquarium to avoid long lines. People generally spend 3-4 hours for the Ultimate Experience Explore the many shops, have lunch at one of the many restaurants. In the evening, watch the light show at the fountains below the Burj Khalifa (takes place every 30 mins from 6pm)
Nov 4 Monday	Spend the day at Wild Wadi Water Park, enjoying thrilling slides, wave pools, and lazy rivers. Takes about 30 mins by car from the hotel to the Water park Park Hours: 10 am to 6:00 pm Deal Alert: Visa Mondays, book using your Visa Card for a ticket price of AED 218 for two instead of the regular price of AED 590. A saving of AED 372 or Rs. 8500 Average time to spend here is 4-6 hours.
Nov 5 Tuesday	In the morning, visit Ski Dubai Snow Park in Mall of Emirates. Takes about 30 mins by car from the hotel to the Snow park (<i>no change in drive time with the hotel change</i>) Park opens at 10 am Average time spent is 3-4 hours

	Two ticket options: AED 440 or AED 520 for two. The more expensive option includes One-time access to the chairlift and Mountain Thriller ride Afterwards spend time at the Mall of Emirates Travel to airport (takes about an hour to get to the airport from the Mall of Emirates)
Nov 6 Wednesday	Catch flight at 00:10 Arrive in Pune at 04:40

Additional Options

These are some other family friendly recommendations, if you would like to replace anything above:

- In the evening, explore the Global Village, a massive cultural theme park featuring pavilions from over 150 countries, showcasing their food, crafts, and entertainment. It opens at 4pm, and is a well-known family-friendly location.
- In the evening, visit the Dubai Miracle garden- the world's largest flower garden and its neighbouring butterfly.

Important Places Around Your Hotels

Dubai - Marriott Marquis Dubai

Convenience stores

[Fresh Concept Foods](#) (1 km - 15 mins walk) - Open from 6 am to 10 pm everyday except on Fridays

[W Mart Supermarket](#) (1.8 km - 4 mins drive) - Open from 7 am to 11:55 pm

There are also other local stores around

Hospital

[Dubai Hospital](#), 222 Al Khaleej St - Deira - Dubai - United Arab Emirates

(15 min taxi drive) - Open 24 hrs

Pharmacy

[Life Pharmacy](#) (10 mins walk) - Open 24 hrs

Mobile Connectivity while in Dubai

- Etisalat and Du are both widely used networks.

- Prepaid SIM cards in the UAE are sometimes available for free, but mostly they are available with the package for AED 50-100 (depending on the plan you select). They can be picked at the airport.
- The packages of these two companies are also slightly different, but DU's packages are slightly cheaper than Etisalat's.
- Etisalat's 4G coverage is very good and is available in every city and region.
- DU's 5G coverage is better than Etisalat's, but its 5G speed is slightly slower than Etisalat's.
- Most people in Dubai use the Du sim cards.

Important Numbers in Dubai

Here are few numbers you may need while in Dubai

- 999- Police
- 997- Fire
- 998- Ambulance
- 995- Find and rescue

Recommended things to buy/carry

- Travel Insurance-. Recommendation- TATA AIG
- The weather on Dubai is very hot- maximum temperatures go upto 37 degrees. Please carry summer caps, sunscreen and pack light cotton clothes. do also ensure that you carry water with you whenever you are stepping out.
- Travel adaptors- Type C, D and G plug adaptor for UAE
- Doctors prescriptions/travel prescriptions for medicines (except over the counter meds)
- Walking shoes!
- Portable chargers (as you will be on the move for most of the time)
- Forex (cash and cards)- our recommendation is the BookMyForex card. Many of our clients have also used the Niyo travel card and have had a good experience.

Common Phrases in Dubai

Arabic Word	Meaning in English
Marhaba	Hello

Kaif Halak?	How are you?
Shukran	Thank you
Na'am	Yes
la	No
Maasalaamah	Goodbye

Recommended Apps

- Google Translate
- Google Maps

Regarding Foreign Currency- Dubai

- AED also *known as the United Arab Emirates dirham* or simply as the Emirati dirham, it is the currency of the United Arab Emirates.
- 1 Dirham is 23 INR
- While most establishments like restaurants and shops accept cards, You will need cash for small shops and in the souk, as well as street food vendors.
- Exchange money before going and carry forex cash and cards. If you need some additional cash while there, the most cost effective way is to use an ATM. Do check with your banks regarding the charges.
- Ensure that the cards you are carrying are activated for international spends.

Getting Around in Dubai

Public Transport

- Please bear in mind that it is **not possible to pay in cash** for any means of public transport in Dubai.
- The NOL card (Nol Card) is a **rechargeable card** that allows all public transport in the city to be used in an easy way
- It can be purchased at any metro station.
- There are different types of Nol cards. The Silver card is recommended for tourists. It costs 25 AED which includes a 19 AED credit.
- Download the RTA Dubai app, for information on schedules and prices and also to recharge the Nol card.
- The Nol card can also be recharged at any of the designated recharge machines available at metro and bus stations.

- Other pointers to consider:
 - Each passenger needs 1 Nol card
 - The minimum card balance is 7.5 AED
 - The maximum balance value is 1,000 AED for Anonymous nol cards and 5,000 AED for Personal and registered cards
 - In order to activate the pending top up, please use your card in any online parking meter, metro gates, nol pay application or Solar Top-up Machines after 45 minutes to 4 hours to update your card balance.
- It is important to remember to swipe the card at the end of your journey, otherwise, you will be charged the maximum fare instead of paying the correct fare.
- The lowest fare is for short journeys of up to 1.8 miles, which allows you 1 transfer of up to 90 minutes. For this option, the price is 3 AED (US\$ 0.80) for silver cards
- You can also use your nol card to pay at certain stores- please refer to this link- <https://www.rta.ae/wps/portal/rta/ae/public-transport/nol/nol-merchants>

Cabs

- You can hail down taxis belonging to the Dubai Taxi Corporation. – these are red topped cars.
- The meter starts at Dhs5 from 6am-10pm, and Dhs5.5 from 10pm-6am and Dhs2.19 per km
- You can also prebook these taxis using the DTC mobile app

Other ride hailing apps

- Careem- which offers the Hala taxi, which are generally affordable rides- Dhs8 starting fee, Dhs12 minimum fare, and Dhs1.91 per km.
- Uber- generally more expensive but since it offers a flat rate, it could work out more affordable during peak hours and for longer distances.

Embassy Info- Dubai

Consulate General of India, Istanbul

[+90 212 296 21 31](tel:+902122962131)

Restaurant options in Dubai

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Speciality	Ambience	Location	Price per person

Asian Lotus Restaurant	Asian Fusion	Pad Thai, Carry Laksa, Prawn Siomai	Indoor and outdoor dining	10 min walk from the hotel	AED 50 - 100
Creek Kitchen	International, Pasta, Pizza. Has a limited menu	Chicken Kabab, Margarita Pizza	Indoor and Patio dining	Inside the Hotel	AED 150-200
Feta Restaurant	Mediterranean	Hummus, Falafel and Shawarma	Indoor dining	5 mins taxi ride from the hotel	AED 50-100
Il Forno	Italian	Alfredo, mushroom soup	Indoor and outdoor dining	Al Ghurair Centre 10 mins taxi ride from the hotel	AED 50-100
Bestoon Samad Iraqi Food Restaurant	Middle Eastern	Lentil soup, dolma	Family dining	10 mins taxi ride from the hotel	AED 50- 150
Bikanerwala	Indian	Breakfast, Quick lunch and dinner Sweet options	Casual	Sheikh Zayed Road	Reasonably priced AED 1-50 per person Open 8am-12 am.
Bombay Chowpatty	Indian street food	Pav Bhaji, Chole Bature, Dosa	Casual	Multiple locations Sheikh Zayed road Mall of Emirates,	Open 8 am-1130 pm AED 1-50 per person

				Dubai Mall	
SpiceKlub	Indian	Vegetarian	Indoor dining	Al Mankhool, Option for when you visit the souks	Modern presentation Open 12-3:30pm 6:30-11:30 pm AED 50-100 per person
Leila	Lebanese	Serves veg and vegan dishes also. Mezze plates, salads, pizzas	Terrace available	Downtown Dubai	10am- 12:45 am
Zaroob	Arabic	Serves veg and vegan dishes also- Mezze plates, salads, pizzas	Live cooking stations on 2 floors recreating Arabic street fare with a twist, in a market setting. Has outdoor seating	Jumeriah Tower Building, Sheik Zayed Road,	AED 50-100 per person
Taquado Mexican Kitchen	Mexican	Veg options, fajitas, burriots and tacos and burgers	Indoor seating	Mall of Emirates	AED 1-50 per person Open 10am-10 pm
Aroos Damascus	Syrian	Serves veg and vegan also-. Mezze plates, salads, mains like moussaka	Has outdoor seating	Sheik Zayed Road	AED 50-100 per person Open 11am- 4 pm
Carluccio	Italian	Pastas and pizzas,	Casual	Dubai Mall	Popular Italian

		handmade foccacia	setting has outdoor seating		chain AED 50-150 per person Open 9am- 12 am
L'eto Dubai	Bakery and cake shop	Pistachio cake, macarons, milk cake	Casual setting	Dubai Mall	Open 9am-12am
TimeOut Market Dubai	Food hall	Baos, pizzas, Phos	casual setting	Near dubai Mall and fountain	Open 12pm-12am
Parkers	French	Matilda Cake, fries, burgers	Casual setting	Dubai Mall	AED 50-150 per item open 9am-11:30ppm
Chocomelt	Chocolate Cafe	Baby Dynamite, Popcorn mountain banana pudding,biscoff crepe	Casual Setting	Dubai Mall	AED 50-100 per item open 10:00 am-12am
Public	Multicuisine (mostly Italian)	Has veg options, Curly corn, pizzas, tiramisu, crazy truffle pasta, parmesan fries,	Casual setting, has outdoor seating too	Dubai Mall	Open 9am-1am
Bosporous Turkish Cuisine	Turkish	Has veg options, mezze platters, cheese rolls, turkish tea	Casual setting, has outdoor seating too	Dubai Mall	Open 8am-12:30am
Hafiz Mustafa 1864	Turkish sweets	Baklava, turkish delights, turkish coffee	Casual setting, has outdoor seating too	Dubai Mall	AED 50-150 per item Open 8am-12:00am

Flaky Pastry Dubai	Bakery and Cake shop	Croissants, cinnamon rolls, coffee, crookie, vanilla flan		City Walk II	AED 50-100 per item open 7:30am-10pm
Fi'lia Dubai	Italian	Has veg dishes. Truffle izza, pavlova, cacio e pepe pasta, tiramisu	Beautiful terrace setting	SLS Dubai Hotels and Residences, Dubai Business Bay.	Open 12:30-3:30 pm 6:30pm-12am Located on the 70th floor Reservations required sevenrooms.com
Bombay Bungalow	Mumbai Street Food	Samosas, pav bhaji	Has outdoor seating	The Beach Mall, JBR Walk	AED 50-150 per person Open 10 am-12 pm
Berenjack Dubai	Persian	Saffron rice, iranian bread, = eggplant, hummus, baklava		Jumeirah	Open 12-5pm 6-11:30pm
Milk Bakery	Bakery and cake shop	Breakfast/brunch, Turkish eggs, Avocado toast, Pastries, milk chocolate cookie, coffee	Casual Seating	Jumeirah	AED 50-100 per item open 7:30am-12am Sat-sun open from 8am

Famous Vegetarian Local Dishes

- **Fattoush:** This vibrant salad is a refreshing and healthy option. It's made with toasted or fried pita bread pieces tossed with chopped vegetables, herbs, and a tangy lemon dressing.

- **Balaleet:** This sweet vermicelli dish is traditionally served for breakfast but can be enjoyed at any time of day. It's made with fried vermicelli noodles, cardamom, saffron, rosewater, and topped with fried nuts and raisins.
- **Mutabbal:** This creamy eggplant dip is a popular mezze dish. It's made with roasted eggplant, tahini, lemon juice, olive oil, and garlic.
- **Moussaka:** This layered eggplant dish is a vegetarian take on the classic Greek dish. It's made with layers of fried eggplant, tomatoes, onions, and a creamy bechamel sauce.
- **Falafel:** A famous Middle Eastern street food, falafel is a deep-fried patty or ball made from ground chickpeas, fava beans, or lentils. It's typically served in a pita bread with hummus, tahini, chopped vegetables, and amba sauce
- **Tabbouleh:** This refreshing salad is a staple of Levantine cuisine. It's made with finely chopped parsley, tomatoes, mint, onions, bulgur wheat, and a lemon dressing
- **Lentil Soup:** Hearty and flavorful, lentil soup is a popular comfort food in Dubai. It's made with lentils, vegetables, and spices.
- **Vegetable Biryani:** This fragrant rice dish is a vegetarian version of the classic Indian biryani. It's made with basmati rice, vegetables, spices, and nuts.
- **Stuffed Grape Leaves:** Also known as yaprak in Turkish cuisine, stuffed grape leaves are a popular appetizer or side dish. They're made with grape leaves stuffed with rice, vegetables, and herbs.
- **Luqaymat-** These homely sweet pastries are shaped into delicate golden balls that melt in the mouth. They're made from flour, sesame seeds, turmeric, milk, sugar, salt, and a little yeast. The batter is kneaded and then left to rest for a while, before being fried in oil and drizzled with syrup.
- **Knafeh-**made of spun pastry, soaked in sweet syrup, layered with melting cheese, and served with clotted cream, pistachio, or other nuts.
- **Khubz or 'Kuboos'** is a classic soft Arabic bread made with all-purpose or wheat flour. Try the freshly made ones at a bakery or restaurant with fresh hummus and an aubergine dip called 'mutabal' as its perfect accompaniment. You can also use the Khubz to wrap all the juicy, delicious ingredients of shawarma, and it can also be paired with any gravy dishes.

What to buy as souvenirs and from where?

Type of souvenir	Category	Where to buy
Dates	Consumable	Popular brands- Bateel Dates, Al Barakah Dates, Date Crown Supermarkets

		Date Souk at the Grand Souk
Spices (Especially saffron, cumin, turmeric and cinnamon)		Supermarkets or the Deira Spice Souk
Arabic coffee		Supermarkets
Camel Milk Chocolate		Brand – Al Nassma kiosks at Dubai Mall Bhurj Khalifa The Palm Souk Madinat Jumeirah
Dried fruits and nuts		Supermarkets
Sweets (Baklava, Khabees, Maamoul, and Batheeth)		Alreef Lebanese Bakery , Al Baba Sweets The Hummingbird Bakery, Mall of Emirates .
Oud and Bakhoor (types of incense)	Personal products (perfume/jewellery /garments/accessories)	Traditional perfume shops in malls and the souks like Perfume Souk in Deira
Gold jewellery		Gold Souk in Deira Joyalukkas outlets
Traditional Arab shoes		Grand Souk
Arabic Attar (concentrated perfumes made from essential oils, musk, amber etc)		Popular brands- Swiss Arabian Perfumes, Rasasi Perfume Traditional perfume shops in malls and the souks like Perfume Souk in Deira

Kaftans		Grand Souk Malls like Dubai Mall Souk Madinat Jumeirah
Carpets	Keepsakes	Souk Madinat Jumeirah Dubai Mall National Iranian Carpets at Jumeirah Beach National Iranian Carpets at Mall of Emirates
Aladdin lamps		Karama Souq
Kava pots and coffee sets		Dubai Coffee Museum Dubai Mall Mall of Emirates
Incense holders		Souks like the Deira Spice Souk Home Décor Stores in malls
Lanterns (made of copper and tin with filigree work)		Dragon Mart Homes R Us
Electronic gadgets	Electronics	Sharaf DG store, Dubai Mall Bur Dubai area's Al-Fahidi Street
Clothes	Fashion	Dubai Outlet Mall Dubai Outlet Village